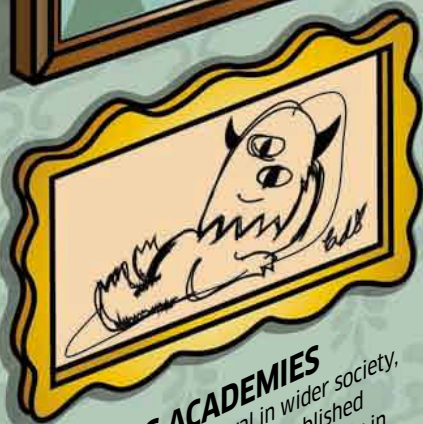


EXHIBITS AHEAD

ANCIENT CRAFTS

Creating and decorating a vase or pot was not an artistic process for the ancient Greeks. Their endeavors were for practical reasons, and the objects were always put to good use. It is only in recent times that people have begun to consider these early works as art—ancient peoples never viewed their crafts this way.



TRAINING ACADEMIES

As artists gained approval in wider society, new academies of art were established in Europe. The first was opened in Italy in 1563, and these academies soon spread across the continent. Subjects including human anatomy and geometry were taught to assist artists with their development, though the concept of art remained limited.

ART APPRECIATION

The perception of painters and sculptors as artists came to light during the 1500s. Captive audiences showed appreciation for new creations, and previously anonymous artists received recognition. Leading the way was Italian Michelangelo (1475–1564), who won the hearts of many with his spectacular painting on the ceiling of the grand Sistine Chapel, covering 12,000 sq. ft. (1,100 m²).

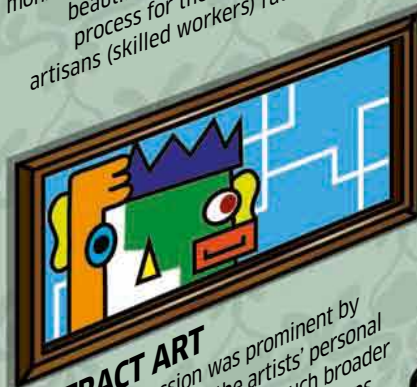
REDEFINING ART

The traditional view of art as something beautiful was flushed away in 1917 when French artist Marcel Duchamp (1887–1968) signed a porcelain men's toilet with a false name and exhibited it. The controversial piece was true to the 20th-century belief that anything was art if the artist deemed it so. The response of the audience and critics was completely another matter!



RELIGIOUS WORKS

During the 1400s, elaborate books were handcrafted across Europe by hard-working monks. Religious works were rewritten alongside beautiful illustrations. It was a laborious process for the monks, who were called artisans (skilled workers) rather than artists.



ABSTRACT ART

Freedom of expression was prominent by the 1800s. Art reflected the artists' personal view of the world, producing a much broader body of creative work. European traditions were ignored as artists enjoyed new experimentation. Art became abstract, evident in the famous paintings of mixed-up faces by Spain's Pablo Picasso (1881–1973).

OUTDOOR EXHIBITS

Art is not always displayed in a gallery in the 21st century. What was previously dismissed as graffiti may now be called art, with U.K. artist Banksy creating striking and recognizable images on public buildings. His work demonstrates that anything goes in today's art scene.



**"A PICTURE IS WORTH
A THOUSAND WORDS."**

Napoleon Bonaparte (1769–1821),
emperor of France